

Landing-Page Build Process — Keyword Map → 30 Templates → Deploy

Version: V1 · 2026-07-09 **Worked example:** pest-template (Elk Pest Pros / elkpestpros.com), 30 pest landing pages, Lufkin TX as the proof city. **Branch:**

`multisite-generator-phase0` (commits `4b92c43` → `b0fcd9d`)

This documents the exact, repeatable process used to go from a keyword map to a full validated page set — and the final deploy step (held pending site config). It is **niche-agnostic**: swap the keyword map + master template + AI prompts and the same steps produce another niche's pages.

The mental model

Three human-authored inputs per niche; everything else is mechanical:

1. **Keyword map** (`keyword_map.json`) — *which* pages exist + each page's target keyword.
2. **Master template(s)** — the reusable block skeleton per archetype.
3. **AI prompts** (`ai_block_types.json` registry) — niche-neutral, `{service}` -driven.

Two generation passes turn a template × city into a live page:

- **Pass A — structure** (`includes/generation/engine.php` → `generate_city_pages()` ;

admin trigger `admin/generate.php` / City Pages tab). Clones the template per city, resolves `{city}` / `{SS}` / `{city_slug}` etc., writes `data/pages/{templateId}_{cityId}.json` , rebuilds `page-index.json` . **No AI, no cost.**

- **Pass B — AI content** (`generate.py` ; admin trigger `admin/ai_generate.php` / AI tab).

Fills each page's AI blocks from the prompt registry. **Costs ~\$0.20/city for 30 pages.**

 Pass A and Pass B are **separate actions** and must run in that order.

Phase 0 — Keyword map (the plan)

Built on the **Keywords tab** → writes `data/keyword_map.json` :

```
`` services[]: { primary, slug, section: home|core|landing, tier, secondary[] } ``
```

- `section: landing` entries = the landing pages to build.
- `primary` = target keyword; `slug` = URL base; `secondary[]` = variant phrasings

that live **on the page**, not as separate URLs (rank-and-rent rule).

Worked example: 30 landing services confirmed complete (primary + slug + 2-5 secondaries each). This is the source list for everything downstream.

Phase 1 — Master template: audit & fix

The proven master (cockroach = extermination archetype) block order: `hero_split` → `trust bar (custom_html)` → `AI city_intro` → `AI feature_columns_local` → `steps` → `mid CTA` → `AI local_relevance` → `AI seasonal_calendar` → `service_cards (related)` → `AI faq_local` → `CTA` → `[services_links]` .

Key facts confirmed:

- **AI prompts are `{service}` -driven** → AI blocks auto-adapt per service, so cloning needs *no* prompt changes and only the *static* blocks need attention.

- `{service}` / `{keyword}` **do NOT resolve in static block text** (only in AI prompts). So for static text, **find/replace is the only lever** — keep the master's pest words consistent (all "cockroach/roach") so one pair-set cleans a clone.

Defect fixed: the Service schema hardcoded `"url":"...cockroach-exterminator-{city_slug}/"` . A word-swap fixes "cockroach" but not the slug base, so every clone's JSON-LD `url` would mismatch its real slug (404). **Fix: drop `url` from the Service node** — the canonical `<link>` already establishes URL identity. (commit `4b92c43`)

Admin: added a **Master Template** section (base-flag partition) to the Templates tab.

Phase 2 — Bulk-generate the noun-service templates (21)

Tool: **Bulk Template Generator** (`admin/templates_save.php` `bulk_generate`). Row format:

`Service | slug-base | primary keyword | find=repl;... | hero|intro|local img | Title` .

- `find=repl` = case-aware whole-word swaps (e.g. `cockroach=termite;cockroaches=termites;roach=termite;roaches=termites`).
- **Dry-run first** — flags △ leftover subject words and △ missing images per row.

(Verified 0 leftover across all 21 before committing.)

- The generator overrides `service` + SEO service fields and forces hero H1 to

`"{service} in {city_state}"` .

Archetype split discovered: of the 30, ~21 are single-pest nouns that fit the extermination master; the other ~9 (inspections, category/plans) are different *intents* needing their own archetype — do **not** force them through one master.

Phase 3 — Images

Media library (`uploads/media/`) held a full katypestpros scrape with `{service}` / `about-{service}` / `best-{service}` triads + per-pest bug photos.

- Coverage vs 21: **16 exact matches, 5 on a neutral pest fallback**

(scorpion/cricket/stink bug/bee/centipede — flagged for future custom art).

- Assigned 3 slots per template: hero (`hs_photo`), city-intro `it_photo` ,

local-relevance `it_photo` . Alt text auto-inherited the swapped service noun.

Phase 4 — Inspection archetype (3)

pest / termite / WDI inspection — built **directly off the master skeleton** (only 3, closely related), termite-inspection flagged as the inspection master. (commit `cbe14a1`)

Static changes (AI blocks reused unchanged — they adapt to `{service}`):

- steps → **"How Our {service} Works": Schedule → On-Site Inspection → Written Report**
- trust bar → Trained Inspectors / Detailed Written Report / Fast Scheduling
- seasonal AI block → **static "What We Inspect"** `feature_columns` (per-service coverage)
- schema `serviceType` per service, no `url`

Validated: termite-inspection × Lufkin renders correct end-to-end.

Phase 5 — Category / plans archetype (5)

residential (master) / commercial / emergency / restaurant pest control + pest control plans. (commit `f219360`)

- **Category pages:** broad multi-pest framing, general treatment steps, "Pests We Treat" grid, seasonal kept. AI blocks adapt to `{service}`.

- **Plans page:** `pricing_cards` — 3 tiers (One-Time / Quarterly / Monthly), feature lists + **"Call for a quote"** and **NO invented prices** (never fabricate pricing/stats); seasonal dropped in favor of pricing.

Phase 6 — Cross-link fix (all 30)

The master's `service_cards` "related services" linked to **old slugs** (`/ant-control` , `/bed-bug-treatment` , `/flea-control` , `/rat-control`) that no longer matched template slugs → 404 on every page. Rewrote **120 links** across all 30 to the real slugs (`ant-exterminator` , etc.). (commit `f219360`)

Recurring lesson: **manually-maintained lists drift from templates.** Same class

of bug hit the `[services_links]` grid (Phase 8).

Phase 7 — Generate the full city page set (Lufkin)

1. **Pass A** — all 30 templates × Lufkin → 30 pages, 0 errors.
2. **Orphan cleanup** — deleted 11 stale page files from previously-removed

templates (they'd pollute the page index, `[services_links]`, and Pass B cost). Rebuilt page-index to a clean 30.

1. **Pass B** — AI content for all 30 (~\$0.20, 76 blocks). 30/30, 0 errors.

Gotchas:

- `force_locked` in **Pass A wipes existing AI content** — don't force-lock over already-filled pages at scale (re-run costs AI again).
- CLI runs as **root**; page files must be `chown www-data:www-data` afterward or the admin can't rewrite them.
- Pass B has a 10-min foreground cap here — run it **in the background** for a full set.

Phase 8 — Schema & services-grid polish

- **SAB homepage LocalBusiness node** added to `seo.schema : PestControlService` with `@id {website}/#localbusiness` (matches the landing pages' `provider @id`), `areaServed` only — **no street address, no geo, no aggregateRating** (the `local_business` config's 4.8/534 is fabricated and must never enter live schema). Correct service-area modeling ("we work in your area"). (commit `fe79515`)
 - `[services_links]` **grid** was showing only 10 of 30: the plugin hides links to pages that don't exist, and its config was a stale 21-item list (old slugs + orphan services). **Regenerated the list from templates.json** → 30 links, 0 broken, everywhere the grid renders. (commit `3c56b1d`)
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Phase 9 — Wire keyword-map secondaries into content

Closed the gap where `keyword_map.secondary[]` was written but never consumed. (commit `b0fcd9d`)

1. **Plumbing:** synced `seo.secondary_keywords` on all 30 templates from the map by slug.
2. **generate.py** : exposed `{secondary_keywords}` in `build_context`

(from the page's `seo.secondary_keywords`).

1. **Prompts:** `city_intro` / `feature_columns_local` / `local_relevance` / `faq_local` now

weave the variants in **naturally, with an explicit anti-stuffing guardrail** (skip terms that don't fit); the FAQ is told to cover the distinct intents.

Validated on termite: "termite control/exterminator/removal" surfaced; "termite fumigation"/"tent fumigation" correctly omitted (don't fit standard treatment) — guardrail working. Note: modern `<meta name="keywords">` is ignored by Google, so `secondary_keywords` is a **data carrier into generation**, not an SEO tag.

Phase 10 — Deploy to elkpestpros.com 🕒 HELD

Model: one multi-city site under elkpestpros.com (all cities as landing pages, one domain, one deploy). Infra is ready: `deploy.json` has FTP + `canonical_domain: https://elkpestpros.com` ; static build does trailing-slash canonicalization + sitemap.

Blockers (parked — must fix before go-live, they hit every page):

- **Logo** — still the Katy Pest Pros image (`header.logo`); body copy says Elk Pest Pros.
- **Phone** — placeholder `(281) 888-8888` display vs. real `936-201-5555` tel;

`site_vars.phone` / `tel` disagree.

Deploy steps (when unblocked):

1. Fix `header.logo` + `site_vars.phone` / `tel` (+ `local_business.lb_logo`).
2. Static build (30 Lufkin pages + homepage).
3. FTP deploy → overwrites the 2 stale pages currently live and adds the other 28.
4. Verify live: 200s on all slugs, `sitemap.xml` , resolved schema, trailing-slash

canonicals, no 301 chains.

Current live state (checked 2026-07-09): elkpestpros.com serves only a stale 2-page prior deploy (termite-treatment + cockroach-exterminator) with broken internal links. **None of this session's 30-page set is deployed yet.**

Commit checkpoints (this branch)

Commit	What
4b92c43	Master Template section + 21 bulk templates + schema-url fix + images
cbe14a1	Inspection archetype (3)
f219360	Category/plans archetype (5) + 120 cross-link fixes
fe79515	SAB homepage LocalBusiness schema
3c56b1d	services_links grid synced to 30
b0fcd9d	keyword-map secondaries wired into generation

Generated city pages are kept **uncommitted as artifacts** (regenerable per real city).

Repeatable checklist for a NEW niche

1. Build the **keyword map** on the Keywords tab (primary + slug + secondaries, by section).
2. Build/adapt the **master template(s)** — one per archetype the niche needs.
3. Fill the **prompt registry** with niche-neutral `{service}`-driven prompts.
4. Sync `secondary_keywords` from the map onto the templates.
5. Bulk-generate noun-service templates; build divergent archetypes directly.
6. Assign images; sync `[services_links]` + related-service cross-links to the templates.
7. Add the SAB homepage LocalBusiness node.
8. Pass A → orphan cleanup → Pass B (background); validate one page per archetype.

9. Set site config (logo, phone, `deploy.json`), build, FTP deploy, verify live.

Standing gotchas

- Manual lists (services_links, related-service cards) **drift** — always re-sync from templates.
- Never fabricate prices/ratings/stats; model service-area businesses with `areaServed`, no address.
- `force_locked` on Pass A wipes AI content; `chown www-data` after any root-run generation.
- Keep the master's static pest words consistent so one find/replace pair-set cleans a clone.